



City of Cambridge

POR 2026-138
FIRST IN COUNCIL
July 23, 2026

COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI

- WHEREAS: While Cambridge has had significantly fewer [homicides per capita than the national average in recent years](#), including [among cities in Massachusetts](#), when violence does occur it is devastating and unacceptable; and
- WHEREAS: Along with state and federal policies related to public safety and firearms, the public safety work and programming run by the City of Cambridge including by the Police Department, the Department of Human Services Programs, the Community Safety Department, the Housing Department, the Multi-Service Center, the Public Health Department, and the Cambridge Health Alliance have had significant impacts in preventing and responding to violence in Cambridge; and
- WHEREAS: It is imperative for the City to holistically evaluate what methods have and have not been successful in responding to violence in order to strengthen policy making around public safety across City departments; and
- WHEREAS: Cambridge's current public safety policies include a Surveillance Technology Ordinance passed by the City Council that authorizes the City to use more than 30 different surveillance technologies, including more than a dozen surveillance technologies requested by the Police Department over the years; and
- WHEREAS: Alongside these important traditional public safety responses, City and community resources including [mental and behavioral healthcare](#), [affordable housing](#), [education](#), and [job training programs](#) have proven to be critical tools in reducing violence in cities across the country; and
- WHEREAS: While these public safety resources across City departments have been critical, it is important to review which programs, policies, and technologies have worked and have not worked in preventing and responding to violent crime, including solved and unsolved murders in Cambridge, and what additional resources or changes would be impactful across City departments; and
- WHEREAS: Community engagement is critical in advancing public safety and new approaches or adoption of technologies must begin with robust community engagement and outreach to communities impacted prior to adoption in order to be effective; and
- WHEREAS: While City departments and community organizations such as Transition House, Remembering Our Cambridge Kids and Kin, and BARCC have done tremendous work to support survivors of violence and their families in Cambridge, there remains

work to be done to ensure that survivors and their families have the resources and support they need; now therefore be it

ORDERED: That the City Manager be and is hereby requested to provide a comprehensive evaluation of violence response and prevention strategies, along with survivor support services, across City departments including CPD, CSD, CHA, and DHSP and come with recommendations before the City Council's Public Safety Committee; and be it further

ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to report back to the City Council in a timely manner.

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Paula M. Crane".

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk



City of Cambridge

That the City Manager is requested to provide a comprehensive evaluation of violence response and prevention strategies, along with survivor support services, across City departments including CPD, CSD, CHA, and DHSP and come with recommendations before the City Council's Public Safety Committee and report back to the City Council in a timely manner.